CYBERSECURITY TRAINING HANDBOOK

SEMESTER 1 ROADMAP (GOVERNMENT■STYLE)

26 Weeks | 6 Days Study (Mon–Sat) | Sunday Revision | Practical■First

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Owner:	Yiga Elvis
Document:	Semester 1 Training Handbook
Version:	v1.0 (Generated)
Date:	March 04, 2026
Usage:	Print■ready; daily guide
Policy:	Authorized labs only. No real■world targeting.

1. Purpose and Policy

This handbook provides a structured 26■week Semester 1 training program. Lab-only unless authorized.

Non■Negotiable Rules

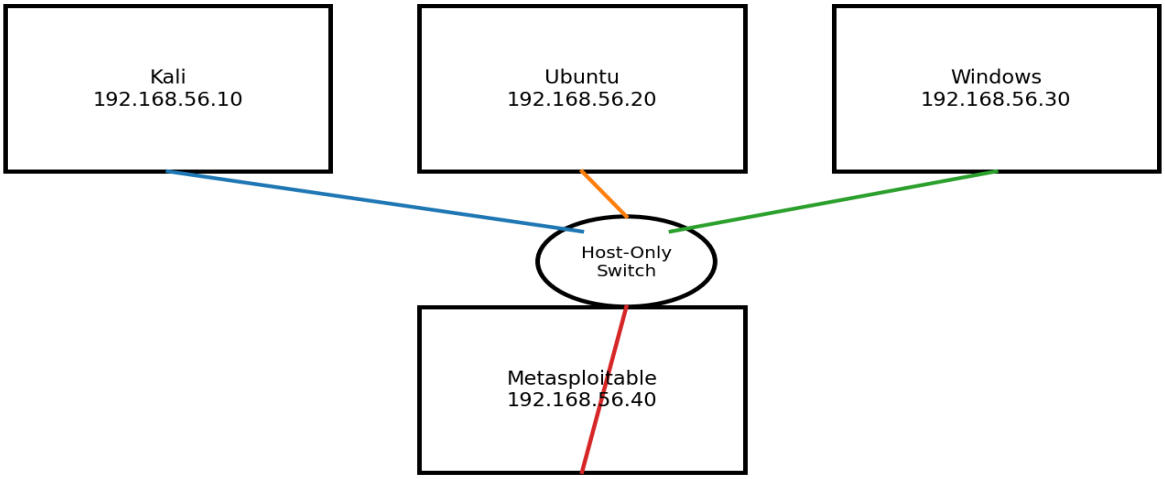
- Study 6 days (Mon–Sat). Sunday revision only.
- Max 2 theory days (Mon–Tue). Practical Wed–Sat.
- Weekly proof: notes + evidence + artifact + report.
- Never target real systems. Authorized environments only.

2. Home Lab (Minimum)

Set up an isolated host-only lab network for all hands-on work.

Component	Recommended	Purpose	Policy Note
Host machine	8GB+ RAM, 100GB+ storage	Run VMs	Keep personal files separate.
Kali VM	2GB RAM, 40GB disk	Tools	Update tools; log changes.
Ubuntu VM	1GB RAM, 20GB disk	Hardening/admin	Harden SSH; firewall baseline.
Windows VM	2GB RAM, 40GB disk	Telemetry	Sysmon for logs.
Targets	Metasploitable/Juice Shop	Training	Never expose to internet.
Network	Host-only 192.168.56.0/24	Isolation	Suggested: .10/.20/.30/.40

Lab Topology (Host-Only Network)



Policy: Lab-only. Snapshot before risky exercises. Keep isolated from real networks.

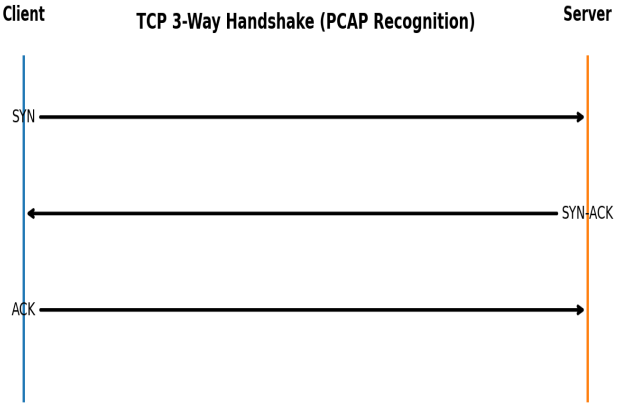
3. Quick Reference Diagrams

Print these and keep them near your desk.

OSI Model (Security Lens)

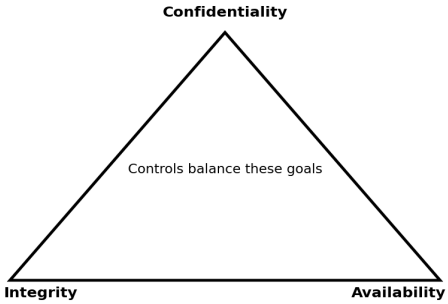
7 Application	HTTP/DNS | Risks: XSS, SQLi
6 Presentation	TLS/Encoding | Risks: weak crypto
5 Session	Sessions | Risks: hijacking
4 Transport	TCP/UDP | Risks: floods
3 Network	IP | Risks: spoofing
2 Data Link	Ethernet/ARP | Risks: ARP poisoning
1 Physical	Cable/RF | Risks: tapping

TCP 3-Way Handshake (PCAP Recognition)

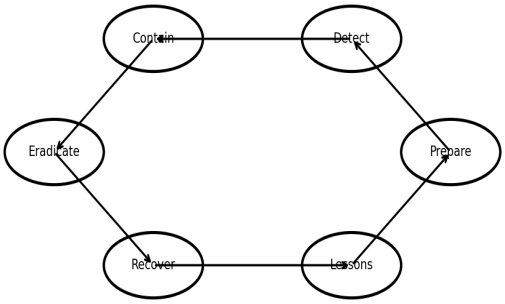


Wireshark filter: tcp.flags.syn==1 && tcp.flags.ack==0

CIA Triad



Incident Response Lifecycle (NIST-style)



Always maintain a timeline + evidence list + decision log.

4. Course Outline (Weeks 1–26)

Month	Week	Theme	Primary Artifact
Month 1	Week 1	Computer Components & OS Fundamentals	Week 1 Evidence Pack + GitHub setup
Month 1	Week 2	Virtualization, Lab Safety & Recovery	Lab RoE + Recovery SOP + Network diagram
Month 1	Week 3	Networking Fundamentals: IP, Subnetting, Routing	Subnet workbook + network diagram
Month 1	Week 4	Protocols & Traffic Analysis: DNS/HTTP/TLS	Wireshark cheat sheet + PCAP report
Month 2	Week 5	Linux Fundamentals: Permissions, Users, Logs	Linux triage checklist + lab writeup
Month 2	Week 6	Linux Hardening + Bash Automation	hardencheck.sh + hardening report
Month 2	Week 7	Python Security Tools v0.1	mini-security-toolkit v0.1
Month 2	Week 8	Python Networking + Crypto Basics	Security reporter v0.2
Month 3	Week 9	Web Fundamentals: Sessions & DevTools	Cookie/session evidence pack
Month 3	Week 10	SQL + Secure Authentication	SQL workbook + auth checklist
Month 3	Week 11	Security Fundamentals: CIA + Threat Modeling	CIA poster + threat model
Month 3	Week 12	IAM: MFA + RBAC + Policies	Identity baseline checklist
Month 4	Week 13	Recon & Scanning (Lab)	Asset inventory report + script
Month 4	Week 14	Vulnerability Scanning & Reporting (Lab)	Vuln report (2–4 pages)
Month 4	Week 15	Web Security I: XSS (Training)	XSS finding report
Month 4	Week 16	Web Security II: SQLi/CSRF/API (Training)	API testing checklist
Month 5	Week 17	Windows Logs + Sysmon	Log export script + SOC summary
Month 5	Week 18	SIEM Fundamentals	Queries + triage playbook
Month 5	Week 19	Incident Response	Incident report template + mock report
Month 5	Week 20	Forensics Basics	Forensics triage report
Month 6	Week 21	Active Directory Fundamentals (Concept)	AD architecture doc + tiering policy concept
Month 6	Week 22	AD Security (Defense)	Hardening checklist + detections list
Month 6	Week 23	Cloud Security Fundamentals	Cloud baseline + logging matrix
Month 6	Week 24	Security Automation: Mini SOC Toolkit	mini-soc-toolkit v1.0
Month 6	Week 25	Capstone 1: Mini Assessment (Lab)	Capstone pentest report
Month 6	Week 26	Capstone 2: Blue Team Scenario + Portfolio	Incident report + portfolio README + CV bul

5. Weekly Modules

Each week has an overview page and an execution/proof page.

Module: Month 1 — Week 1

Computer Components & OS Fundamentals

Build core foundations: hardware, OS architecture, boot process, privilege boundaries, and baseline security hygiene.

Certification alignment: A+ (alignment), Security+ (foundation)	Tools focus: VirtualBox, Linux CLI

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Security starts at the lowest layer: firmware → bootloader → kernel → user space.
- Patch management and least privilege are core controls.
- Lab discipline: snapshots + documentation.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain key hardware/OS concepts with security examples.
- Build first VM and document baseline.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Week 1 Evidence Pack + GitHub setup
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 1

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Hardware basics + threat examples.	Create Kali VM and capture VM settings.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	OS concepts: kernel, processes, updates.	Compare Windows/Linux outputs.	Comparison notes.
Wed (Practical)	Boot process and file systems.	Read boot logs; take CLEAN-W1 snapshot.	Boot diagram + snapshot.
Thu (Practical)	Processes/memory basics.	Process listing evidence.	Writeup.
Fri (Practical)	Accounts & hygiene.	Create users and document policy.	Evidence pack.
Sat (Practical)	Consolidation: portfolio folders + Git repo.	Push notes + evidence.	Repo updated.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + quiz.	Redo boot explanation.	Score + weak areas.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Install Kali VM and take CLEAN snapshot.
- Create users (admin + standard) and apply least privilege.
- Write a boot process diagram.

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page boot explanation with security notes.
- Create a labeled hardware diagram.
- Create 20 practice questions and answer them.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe: Pre-Security modules.
- TryHackMe: Linux Fundamentals Part 1.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: PC Setup & IT Support (Authorized)
- Market note: OS install/cleanup, backups, performance tune-up.
- How to start: Deliver checklist + short report + before/after proof.

References (official/free)

- Microsoft Learn: https://learn.microsoft.com/
- VirtualBox Manual: https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 1 — Week 2

Virtualization, Lab Safety & Recovery

Professionalize your lab: snapshots, network isolation, safe testing rules, and backup/restore procedures.

Certification alignment: Network+ (alignment)	Tools focus: SSH, UFW, nmap (lab)

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Snapshots are mandatory before risky activity.
- Host-only networking keeps labs isolated.
- Write lab RoE + restore SOP.

Learning Outcomes

- Configure host-only network with static IPs.
- Set up SSH key auth.
- Create restore SOP.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Lab RoE + Recovery SOP + Network diagram
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 2

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Storage + partitions overview.	Inspect partitions (lsblk/fdisk).	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Virtualization + network modes.	Configure host-only + static IP plan.	Connectivity proof.
Wed (Practical)	Kali setup + updates.	Install core tools and document versions.	Tool list.
Thu (Practical)	Ubuntu baseline hardening.	SSH keys + UFW rules.	Evidence pack.
Fri (Practical)	Backup/restore drill.	Restore snapshot; record time.	Restore SOP.
Sat (Practical)	Full base lab verification.	nmap host discovery (lab).	Scan evidence.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + timed rebuild.	Rebuild SSH key auth.	Score + time.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Host-only network plan.
- SSH key authentication.
- Restore drill and documented SOP.

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write Lab Rules of Engagement (1 page).
- Draw lab topology with IP plan.
- Create snapshot policy checklist.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe: Introductory Networking.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Virtual Lab Setup Service (Authorized)
- Market note: Stable lab setups + documentation.
- How to start: Deliver lab diagram + SOP + screenshots.

References (official/free)

- Kali Docs: https://www.kali.org/docs/
- VirtualBox Networking: https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/ch06.html

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 1 — Week 3

Networking Fundamentals: IP, Subnetting, Routing

Master subnetting and core network behavior; produce diagrams and packet evidence.

Certification alignment: Network+ (alignment)	Tools focus: Wireshark, ipcalc

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: IP addressing, CIDR/subnetting, routing basics.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: IP addressing, CIDR/subnetting, routing basics.
- Complete labs: Subnet worksheet + ipcalc, Wireshark ARP/DNS capture.
- Produce and publish: Subnet workbook + network diagram.
- Write a scenario report for: Write 1-page ARP/DNS analysis from PCAP.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Subnet workbook + network diagram
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 3

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: IP addressing, CIDR/subnetting, routing basics (risks + defenses).	Start Subnet worksheet + ipcalc and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Networking Fundamentals: IP, Subnetting, Routing.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Subnet worksheet + ipcalc	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Wireshark ARP/DNS capture	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Subnet workbook + network diagram	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Write 1-page ARP/DNS analysis from PCAP	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Subnet worksheet + ipcalc
- Lab: Wireshark ARP/DNS capture
- Build: Subnet workbook + network diagram
- Scenario: Write 1-page ARP/DNS analysis from PCAP

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Secure Wi■Fi/Router Setup & Diagram Service (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Cloudflare: https://www.cloudflare.com/learning/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 1 — Week 4

Protocols & Traffic Analysis: DNS/HTTP/TLS

Read traffic like an analyst and write a PCAP report.

Certification alignment: Network+ (alignment)	Tools focus: Wireshark, tcpdump

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: TCP/UDP, DNS, HTTP, TLS overview.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: TCP/UDP, DNS, HTTP, TLS overview.
- Complete labs: Wireshark filter drills, tcpdump capture.
- Produce and publish: Wireshark cheat sheet + PCAP report.
- Write a scenario report for: SOC-style note from a sample PCAP.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Wireshark cheat sheet + PCAP report
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 4

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: TCP/UDP, DNS, HTTP, TLS overview (risks + defenses).	Start Wireshark filter drills and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Protocols & Traffic Analysis: DNS/HTTP/TLS.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Wireshark filter drills	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	tcpdump capture	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Wireshark cheat sheet + PCAP report	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	SOC-style note from a sample PCAP	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Wireshark filter drills
- Lab: tcpdump capture
- Build: Wireshark cheat sheet + PCAP report
- Scenario: SOC-style note from a sample PCAP

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Traffic Troubleshooting & Audit (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Wireshark: https://www.wireshark.org/docs/
- MDN HTTP: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTTP

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 2 — Week 5

Linux Fundamentals: Permissions, Users, Logs

Linux comfort for security work: permissions and logs.

Certification alignment: Linux+ (concept)	Tools focus: grep/awk/sed, find

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: FHS, permissions, users/groups, log analysis.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: FHS, permissions, users/groups, log analysis.
- Complete labs: Permissions lab, Log parsing (grep/awk/sed).
- Produce and publish: Linux triage checklist + lab writeup.
- Write a scenario report for: Auth log analysis report.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Linux triage checklist + lab writeup
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 5

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: FHS, permissions, users/groups, log analysis (risks + defenses).	Start Permissions lab and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Linux Fundamentals: Permissions, Users, Logs.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Permissions lab	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Log parsing (grep/awk/sed)	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Linux triage checklist + lab writeup	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Auth log analysis report	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Permissions lab
- Lab: Log parsing (grep/awk/sed)
- Build: Linux triage checklist + lab writeup
- Scenario: Auth log analysis report

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Linux Server Setup & Hardening (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- OverTheWire: https://overthewire.org/wargames/bandit/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 2 — Week 6

Linux Hardening + Bash Automation

Reduce attack surface; automate baseline checks.

Certification alignment: Linux+ (concept)	Tools focus: UFW, SSH, bash

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: systemd, SSH hardening, UFW, bash.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: systemd, SSH hardening, UFW, bash.
- Complete labs: SSH+UFW baseline, Baseline checker script.
- Produce and publish: hardencheck.sh + hardening report.
- Write a scenario report for: Harden fresh Ubuntu VM and prove changes.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- hardencheck.sh + hardening report
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 6

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: systemd, SSH hardening, UFW, bash (risks + defenses).	Start SSH+UFW baseline and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Linux Hardening + Bash Automation.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	SSH+UFW baseline	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Baseline checker script	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	hardencheck.sh + hardening report	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Harden fresh Ubuntu VM and prove changes	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: SSH+UFW baseline
- Lab: Baseline checker script
- Build: hardencheck.sh + hardening report
- Scenario: Harden fresh Ubuntu VM and prove changes

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Hardening Checklist Delivery (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- UFW: https://help.ubuntu.com/community/UFW

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 2 — Week 7

Python Security Tools v0.1

Build small tools: hashing, auditing, reporting.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: Python, hashlib

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: Python, argparse, hashlib, report output.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: Python, argparse, hashlib, report output.
- Complete labs: Password checker, File hasher.
- Produce and publish: mini-security-toolkit v0.1.
- Write a scenario report for: JSON/CSV report from tool outputs.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- mini-security-toolkit v0.1
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 7

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: Python, argparse, hashlib, report output (risks + defenses).	Start Password checker and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Python Security Tools v0.1.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Password checker	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	File hasher	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	mini-security-toolkit v0.1	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	JSON/CSV report from tool outputs	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Password checker
- Lab: File hasher
- Build: mini-security-toolkit v0.1
- Scenario: JSON/CSV report from tool outputs

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Automation Scripts + Reporting (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Python: https://docs.python.org/3/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 2 — Week 8

Python Networking + Crypto Basics

Lab-safe port checks and crypto intuition.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: Python requests, regex

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: requests/HTTP, regex, hashing vs encryption, TLS.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: requests/HTTP, regex, hashing vs encryption, TLS.
- Complete labs: Lab-safe port checker, IOC extractor.
- Produce and publish: Security reporter v0.2.
- Write a scenario report for: 1-page crypto briefing.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Security reporter v0.2
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 8

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: requests/HTTP, regex, hashing vs encryption, TLS (risks + defenses).	Start Lab-safe port checker and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Python Networking + Crypto Basics.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Lab-safe port checker	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	IOC extractor	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Security reporter v0.2	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	1-page crypto briefing	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Lab-safe port checker
- Lab: IOC extractor
- Build: Security reporter v0.2
- Scenario: 1-page crypto briefing

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Weekly Monitoring + Report (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Cloudflare TLS: https://www.cloudflare.com/learning/ssl/what-is-tls/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Consolidation Week (After Week 8) — Consolidation 1 (End Month 2)

Structured consolidation: fix weak areas and improve evidence/report quality.

Mandatory Tasks

- Redo 3 key labs from the previous 8 weeks (no notes; timed).
- Rewrite notes from memory; compare with originals; update weak sections.
- Polish 2 reports (clarity, screenshots, remediation quality).
- Refactor 2 scripts: better error handling + better README + sample output.
- Update portfolio README with improved summaries and pinned artifacts.
- Take a 60-question mixed self-test; record score and weak areas.

Output Required

- Consolidation summary report (2 pages).
- Updated portfolio README + pinned top 5 artifacts.
- Self-test score record + plan for next month.

Module: Month 3 — Week 9

Web Fundamentals: Sessions & DevTools

Web behavior + cookies/sessions.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: DevTools, curl

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: HTTP, cookies/sessions, same-origin.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: HTTP, cookies/sessions, same-origin.
- Complete labs: DevTools inspection, Proxy basics.
- Produce and publish: Cookie/session evidence pack.
- Write a scenario report for: Session mistakes report.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Cookie/session evidence pack
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 9

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: HTTP, cookies/sessions, same-origin (risks + defenses).	Start DevTools inspection and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Web Fundamentals: Sessions & DevTools.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	DevTools inspection	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Proxy basics	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Cookie/session evidence pack	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Session mistakes report	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: DevTools inspection
- Lab: Proxy basics
- Build: Cookie/session evidence pack
- Scenario: Session mistakes report

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Web Debugging Checklist (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- MDN: https://developer.mozilla.org/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 3 — Week 10

SQL + Secure Authentication

SQL basics and secure auth concepts.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: SQLite/MySQL

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: SQL, auth flows, hashing concepts.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: SQL, auth flows, hashing concepts.
- Complete labs: SQL queries workbook, SQLi labs (training).
- Produce and publish: SQL workbook + auth checklist.
- Write a scenario report for: 1 SQLi finding report.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- SQL workbook + auth checklist
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 10

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: SQL, auth flows, hashing concepts (risks + defenses).	Start SQL queries workbook and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for SQL + Secure Authentication.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	SQL queries workbook	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	SQLi labs (training)	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	SQL workbook + auth checklist	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	1 SQLi finding report	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: SQL queries workbook
- Lab: SQLi labs (training)
- Build: SQL workbook + auth checklist
- Scenario: 1 SQLi finding report

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: DB Security Checklist (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- OWASP SQLi: https://owasp.org/www-community/attacks/SQL_Injection

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 3 — Week 11

Security Fundamentals: CIA + Threat Modeling

Security mindset and frameworks.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: Threat modeling

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: CIA, threat modeling, crypto basics.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: CIA, threat modeling, crypto basics.
- Complete labs: Threat model lab, Hashing demo.
- Produce and publish: CIA poster + threat model.
- Write a scenario report for: Awareness poster.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- CIA poster + threat model
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 11

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: CIA, threat modeling, crypto basics (risks + defenses).	Start Threat model lab and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Security Fundamentals: CIA + Threat Modeling.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Threat model lab	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Hashing demo	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	CIA poster + threat model	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Awareness poster	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Threat model lab
- Lab: Hashing demo
- Build: CIA poster + threat model
- Scenario: Awareness poster

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Security Awareness Training (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- NIST CSF: https://www.nist.gov/cyberframework

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 3 — Week 12

IAM: MFA + RBAC + Policies

Identity baseline discipline.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: Windows/Linux accounts

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: auth/authz, MFA, RBAC.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: auth/authz, MFA, RBAC.
- Complete labs: Account audit, RBAC design.
- Produce and publish: Identity baseline checklist.
- Write a scenario report for: Access review report.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Identity baseline checklist
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 12

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: auth/authz, MFA, RBAC (risks + defenses).	Start Account audit and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for IAM: MFA + RBAC + Policies.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Account audit	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	RBAC design	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Identity baseline checklist	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Access review report	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Account audit
- Lab: RBAC design
- Build: Identity baseline checklist
- Scenario: Access review report

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Account Security Guidance (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- NIST 800-63: https://csrc.nist.gov/publications/sp/800-63

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 4 — Week 13

Recon & Scanning (Lab)

Ethical recon and inventory.

Certification alignment: eJPT (alignment)	Tools focus: nmap, netcat

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: nmap, enumeration, inventory reporting.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: nmap, enumeration, inventory reporting.
- Complete labs: Scan lab subnet, Enumerate one service.
- Produce and publish: Asset inventory report + script.
- Write a scenario report for: Remediation plan.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Asset inventory report + script
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 13

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: nmap, enumeration, inventory reporting (risks + defenses).	Start Scan lab subnet and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Recon & Scanning (Lab).	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Scan lab subnet	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Enumerate one service	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Asset inventory report + script	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Remediation plan	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Scan lab subnet
- Lab: Enumerate one service
- Build: Asset inventory report + script
- Scenario: Remediation plan

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Asset Inventory Report Service (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Nmap: https://nmap.org/book/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 4 — Week 14

Vulnerability Scanning & Reporting (Lab)

CVE/CVSS and professional reporting.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: OpenVAS (optional)

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: CVE, CVSS, validation, remediation.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: CVE, CVSS, validation, remediation.
- Complete labs: Lab scan, Validate one finding.
- Produce and publish: Vuln report (2–4 pages).
- Write a scenario report for: Remediation checklist.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Vuln report (2–4 pages)
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 14

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: CVE, CVSS, validation, remediation (risks + defenses).	Start Lab scan and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Vulnerability Scanning & Reporting (Lab).	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Lab scan	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Validate one finding	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Vuln report (2–4 pages)	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Remediation checklist	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Lab scan
- Lab: Validate one finding
- Build: Vuln report (2–4 pages)
- Scenario: Remediation checklist

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Vuln Scan + Remediation (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- NVD: https://nvd.nist.gov/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 4 — Week 15

Web Security I: XSS (Training)

XSS basics and prevention.

Certification alignment: eJPT (alignment)	Tools focus: Burp, DevTools

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: XSS, encoding, cookie flags.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: XSS, encoding, cookie flags.
- Complete labs: XSS labs, Prevention checklist.
- Produce and publish: XSS finding report.
- Write a scenario report for: Demo site review note.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- XSS finding report
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 15

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: XSS, encoding, cookie flags (risks + defenses).	Start XSS labs and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Web Security I: XSS (Training).	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	XSS labs	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Prevention checklist	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	XSS finding report	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Demo site review note	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: XSS labs
- Lab: Prevention checklist
- Build: XSS finding report
- Scenario: Demo site review note

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Web Security Review (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- PortSwigger: https://portswigger.net/web-security

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 4 — Week 16

Web Security II: SQLi/CSRF/API (Training)

Common web vulns and API testing.

Certification alignment: eJPT (alignment)	Tools focus: Burp, curl/Postman

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: SQLi, CSRF, API auth.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: SQLi, CSRF, API auth.
- Complete labs: SQLi/CSRF labs, API tests.
- Produce and publish: API testing checklist.
- Write a scenario report for: 1 finding report.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- API testing checklist
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 16

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: SQLi, CSRF, API auth (risks + defenses).	Start SQLi/CSRF labs and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Web Security II: SQLi/CSRF/API (Training).	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	SQLi/CSRF labs	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	API tests	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	API testing checklist	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	1 finding report	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: SQLi/CSRF labs
- Lab: API tests
- Build: API testing checklist
- Scenario: 1 finding report

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: API Security Checklist (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- OWASP API: https://owasp.org/www-project-api-security/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Consolidation Week (After Week 16) — Consolidation 2 (End Month 4)

Structured consolidation: fix weak areas and improve evidence/report quality.

Mandatory Tasks

- Redo 3 key labs from the previous 8 weeks (no notes; timed).
- Rewrite notes from memory; compare with originals; update weak sections.
- Polish 2 reports (clarity, screenshots, remediation quality).
- Refactor 2 scripts: better error handling + better README + sample output.
- Update portfolio README with improved summaries and pinned artifacts.
- Take a 60-question mixed self-test; record score and weak areas.

Output Required

- Consolidation summary report (2 pages).
- Updated portfolio README + pinned top 5 artifacts.
- Self-test score record + plan for next month.

Module: Month 5 — Week 17

Windows Logs + Sysmon

Telemetry and evidence on endpoints.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: Sysmon, PowerShell

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: Event logs, Sysmon, PowerShell triage.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: Event logs, Sysmon, PowerShell triage.
- Complete labs: Install Sysmon, Export logs.
- Produce and publish: Log export script + SOC summary.
- Write a scenario report for: 10 detection ideas.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Log export script + SOC summary
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 17

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: Event logs, Sysmon, PowerShell triage (risks + defenses).	Start Install Sysmon and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Windows Logs + Sysmon.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Install Sysmon	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Export logs	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Log export script + SOC summary	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	10 detection ideas	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Install Sysmon
- Lab: Export logs
- Build: Log export script + SOC summary
- Scenario: 10 detection ideas

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Endpoint Visibility Setup (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Sysmon: https://learn.microsoft.com/sysinternals/downloads/sysmon

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 5 — Week 18

SIEM Fundamentals

Queries, dashboards, triage.

Certification alignment: SOC readiness	Tools focus: Elastic/Splunk (optional)

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: SIEM, queries, alerts.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: SIEM, queries, alerts.
- Complete labs: Write 6 queries, Design dashboard.
- Produce and publish: Queries + triage playbook.
- Write a scenario report for: Alert triage simulation.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Queries + triage playbook
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 18

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: SIEM, queries, alerts (risks + defenses).	Start Write 6 queries and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for SIEM Fundamentals.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Write 6 queries	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Design dashboard	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Queries + triage playbook	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Alert triage simulation	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Write 6 queries
- Lab: Design dashboard
- Build: Queries + triage playbook
- Scenario: Alert triage simulation

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Dashboards + Detections Pack (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Elastic: https://www.elastic.co/guide/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 5 — Week 19

Incident Response

IR lifecycle and reporting.

Certification alignment: Security+ (alignment)	Tools focus: IR templates

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: NIST IR, containment, evidence, reporting.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: NIST IR, containment, evidence, reporting.
- Complete labs: Tabletop, Write report template.
- Produce and publish: Incident report template + mock report.
- Write a scenario report for: First 30-min checklist.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Incident report template + mock report
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 19

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: NIST IR, containment, evidence, reporting (risks + defenses).	Start Tabletop and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Incident Response.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Tabletop	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Write report template	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Incident report template + mock report	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	First 30-min checklist	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Tabletop
- Lab: Write report template
- Build: Incident report template + mock report
- Scenario: First 30-min checklist

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: IR Templates (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- NIST 800-61: https://csrc.nist.gov/publications/detail/sp/800-61/rev-2/final

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 5 — Week 20

Forensics Basics

Evidence, hashing, timelines.

Certification alignment: DFIR readiness	Tools focus: hashing tools

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: hashing, evidence handling, timelines.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: hashing, evidence handling, timelines.
- Complete labs: Collect artifacts, Timeline table.
- Produce and publish: Forensics triage report.
- Write a scenario report for: Chain-of-custody evidence list.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Forensics triage report
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 20

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: hashing, evidence handling, timelines (risks + defenses).	Start Collect artifacts and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Forensics Basics.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Collect artifacts	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Timeline table	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Forensics triage report	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Chain-of-custody evidence list	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Collect artifacts
- Lab: Timeline table
- Build: Forensics triage report
- Scenario: Chain-of-custody evidence list

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Forensics Triage (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Volatility: https://www.volatilityfoundation.org/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 6 — Week 21

Active Directory Fundamentals (Concept)

Enterprise identity basics and secure design.

Certification alignment: Enterprise readiness	Tools focus: AD concepts

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: domain concepts, Kerberos overview, GPO.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: domain concepts, Kerberos overview, GPO.
- Complete labs: Draw architecture, OU/GPO plan.
- Produce and publish: AD architecture doc + tiering policy concept.
- Write a scenario report for: Management briefing.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- AD architecture doc + tiering policy concept
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 21

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: domain concepts, Kerberos overview, GPO (risks + defenses).	Start Draw architecture and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Active Directory Fundamentals (Concept).	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Draw architecture	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	OU/GPO plan	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	AD architecture doc + tiering policy concept	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Management briefing	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Draw architecture
- Lab: OU/GPO plan
- Build: AD architecture doc + tiering policy concept
- Scenario: Management briefing

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: AD Documentation (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- Microsoft Learn: https://learn.microsoft.com/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 6 — Week 22

AD Security (Defense)

Hardening and detection thinking.

Certification alignment: SOC readiness	Tools focus: Sysmon/events

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: privileged groups, logging, baseline controls.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: privileged groups, logging, baseline controls.
- Complete labs: Hardening checklist, Detection list.
- Produce and publish: Hardening checklist + detections list.
- Write a scenario report for: SOC runbook scenario.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Hardening checklist + detections list
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 22

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: privileged groups, logging, baseline controls (risks + defenses).	Start Hardening checklist and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for AD Security (Defense).	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Hardening checklist	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Detection list	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Hardening checklist + detections list	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	SOC runbook scenario	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Hardening checklist
- Lab: Detection list
- Build: Hardening checklist + detections list
- Scenario: SOC runbook scenario

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: AD Hardening Pack (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- SigmaHQ: https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 6 — Week 23

Cloud Security Fundamentals

IAM, logging, storage baseline patterns.

Certification alignment: Cloud readiness	Tools focus: JSON/YAML

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: IAM, logging, storage.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: IAM, logging, storage.
- Complete labs: Baseline checklist, IAM policy examples.
- Produce and publish: Cloud baseline + logging matrix.
- Write a scenario report for: Leaked keys mini playbook.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Cloud baseline + logging matrix
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 23

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: IAM, logging, storage (risks + defenses).	Start Baseline checklist and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Cloud Security Fundamentals.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Baseline checklist	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	IAM policy examples	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Cloud baseline + logging matrix	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Leaked keys mini playbook	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Baseline checklist
- Lab: IAM policy examples
- Build: Cloud baseline + logging matrix
- Scenario: Leaked keys mini playbook

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Cloud Baseline Review (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- AWS Security: https://docs.aws.amazon.com/security/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 6 — Week 24

Security Automation: Mini SOC Toolkit

Productize automation scripts with documentation.

Certification alignment: Security engineering readiness	Tools focus: Python, Git

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: automation, tool packaging, documentation.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: automation, tool packaging, documentation.
- Complete labs: Build toolkit, Sample reports.
- Produce and publish: mini-soc-toolkit v1.0.
- Write a scenario report for: Runbook for junior analyst.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- mini-soc-toolkit v1.0
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 24

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: automation, tool packaging, documentation (risks + defenses).	Start Build toolkit and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Security Automation: Mini SOC Toolkit.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Build toolkit	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Sample reports	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	mini-soc-toolkit v1.0	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Runbook for junior analyst	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Build toolkit
- Lab: Sample reports
- Build: mini-soc-toolkit v1.0
- Scenario: Runbook for junior analyst

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Automation Tool Productization (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- GitHub Docs: https://docs.github.com/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 6 — Week 25

Capstone 1: Mini Assessment (Lab)

Scope, test lab target, and write report.

Certification alignment: eJPT readiness	Tools focus: nmap, Burp

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: scope, methodology, findings, remediation.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: scope, methodology, findings, remediation.
- Complete labs: Assess lab target, Write report.
- Produce and publish: Capstone pentest report.
- Write a scenario report for: 2 finding writeups.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Capstone pentest report
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 25

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: scope, methodology, findings, remediation (risks + defenses).	Start Assess lab target and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Capstone 1: Mini Assessment (Lab).	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Assess lab target	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Write report	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Capstone pentest report	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	2 finding writeups	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Assess lab target
- Lab: Write report
- Build: Capstone pentest report
- Scenario: 2 finding writeups

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Professional Security Reporting (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- OWASP WSTG: https://owasp.org/www-project-web-security-testing-guide/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Module: Month 6 — Week 26

Capstone 2: Blue Team Scenario + Portfolio

Mock incident report + portfolio polish + interview prep.

Certification alignment: Job readiness	Tools focus: Sysmon, GitHub

Key Notes (Read Twice)

- Primary topics: SOC workflow, timeline, portfolio, interviews.
- Mon–Tue = theory + notes + quiz; Wed–Sat = labs + artifact + report.
- Always include prevention/remediation notes; always collect evidence.
- Sunday revision = redo 1 lab without notes and record your score.

Learning Outcomes

- Explain and demonstrate: SOC workflow, timeline, portfolio, interviews.
- Complete labs: Mock incident, Portfolio cleanup.
- Produce and publish: Incident report + portfolio README + CV bullets.
- Write a scenario report for: Interview Q&A; pack.

Portfolio Artifact (Required Submission)

- Incident report + portfolio README + CV bullets
- Include evidence and a short README.
- Write at least one professional report/writeup this week.

Execution Plan — Week 26

Daily plan: 2 theory days, 4 practical days, Sunday revision.

Daily Plan (Mon–Sat study | Sun revision)

Day	Theory Focus	Hands■On Lab	Deliverable / Proof
Mon (Theory)	Theory: SOC workflow, timeline, portfolio, interviews (risks + defenses).	Start Mock incident and record steps.	Notes + evidence.
Tue (Theory)	Theory: testing/detection/fixing for Capstone 2: Blue Team Scenario + Portfolio.	Create checklist + 10-question quiz.	Checklist + score.
Wed (Practical)	Lab 1 practical.	Mock incident	Writeup + evidence.
Thu (Practical)	Lab 2 tool mastery.	Portfolio cleanup	Tool log + evidence.
Fri (Practical)	Build artifact.	Incident report + portfolio README + CV bullets	Artifact + README.
Sat (Practical)	Scenario + report.	Interview Q&A; pack	1–3 page report.
Sun (Revision)	Revision + self-test.	Redo lab + 20-question test.	Revision sheet + score.

Lab Tasks (Required)

- Lab: Mock incident
- Lab: Portfolio cleanup
- Build: Incident report + portfolio README + CV bullets
- Scenario: Interview Q&A; pack

End-of-Week Exercises

- Write a 1-page briefing (risks + defenses).
- Create a junior-analyst checklist.
- Add 10 practice questions (with answers).
- Refactor one older artifact for quality.

Platform Targets (Proof)

- TryHackMe/HTB: 1 topic module.
- If web: 1 PortSwigger lab.

Money■Generating Concept (Ethical and Authorized)

- Skill learned: Portfolio-to-Job Conversion (Authorized)
- Market note: Sell the result: checklist + evidence + short report (authorized only).
- How to start: Start with authorized local support; deliver documentation.

References (official/free)

- MITRE ATT&CK;: https://attack.mitre.org/

Submission Checklist

- Notes summarized (10 bullets).
- At least 2 labs completed with evidence saved.
- 1 artifact committed (with README).
- 1 report/writeup produced (1–3 pages).
- Sunday revision done + score recorded.
- Portfolio organized.

Appendix A — Vulnerability Finding Template

Section	What to write
Title	Short, specific finding name.
Severity	Critical/High/Medium/Low + reason.
Affected Asset	Host/IP/app endpoint (authorized scope).
Evidence	Screenshots/commands/PCAP/log references.
Impact	What could happen; map to CIA.
Root Cause	Misconfiguration / code flaw / missing control.
Remediation	Fix steps + prevention guidance.
Verification	Confirm fix (before/after).

Appendix B — Incident Report Template

Section	What to write
Executive Summary	What happened + impact + status.
Timeline	Timestamps + evidence + actions.
Detection	How detected (alert/user/logs).
Scope	Systems/accounts/data.
Containment	Actions to stop impact.
Eradication	Removal steps.
Recovery	Restore/monitor/validate.
IOCs	Domains/IPs/hashes (if any).
Lessons Learned	Improvements and controls.
Appendix	Evidence exports/hashes.

Appendix C — Command Cheat Sheets

Linux quick triage

Commands

```
whoami; id; groups; hostname -I; uname -a; cat /etc/os-release
ps aux --forest | head; ss -tulnp; ip a; ip r; arp -a
journalctl -b -n 50; tail -n 50 /var/log/auth.log
sudo -l; find / -perm -4000 2>/dev/null | head
```

Networking (lab)

Commands

```
ping ; traceroute ; ip route; ip neigh
dig A; dig MX; dig -x
nmap -sn 192.168.56.0/24 (lab); nmap -sV (lab)
tcpdump -i eth0 -w cap.pcap; tcpdump -r cap.pcap | head
Wireshark filter: tcp.flags.syn==1 && tcp.flags.ack==0
```